

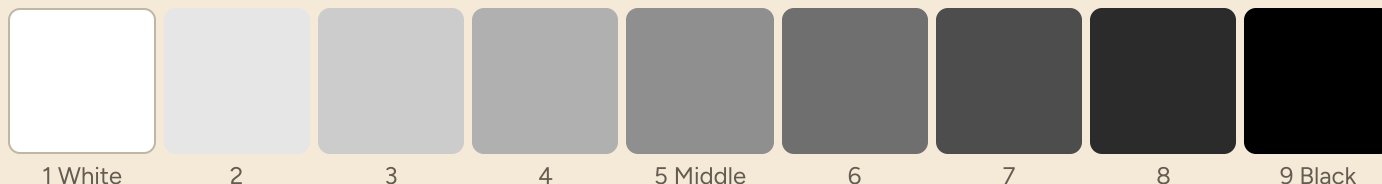
Values & Form

Value is what makes form visible.

Before we worry about color, texture, or detail, we need to learn to see the difference between light, middle, and dark. Everything we draw is affected by light — our job as artists is to observe those changes and translate them into marks.

1. What Is Value?

Value is the relative lightness or darkness of something. You don't need to use all nine values in every drawing — the important thing is learning to see the differences.



2. How Value Creates Form

A circle is a flat shape. Add carefully placed values and it begins to look like a sphere. The same principle works with every form: **Shape → Value → Form.**

Don't shade randomly — ask: where is the light coming from, what faces the light, where does the form turn away, where is the darkest area, and where does the object cast its shadow?

3. Form Shadow & Cast Shadow

Form shadow — the shadow on the object itself, where the surface turns away from the light.

Cast shadow — the shadow the object throws onto another surface. It tells us where the object sits and where the light comes from. A good drawing uses both.

4. Ways to Create Value

Block Shading

Side of the pencil for broad tone. Best for large areas, smooth transitions.

Scumbling

Loose, overlapping marks. Best for organic, rough, or foliage textures.

Cross-Hatching

Layer lines over one another. More layers, closer lines = darker.

Linear Shading

Lines varied in pressure, spacing, direction, length describe the surface.

5. The Drawing Process

1. Find the Form

Sphere • Cone • Cylinder • Box

2. Establish the Light

Decide where it comes from.

3. Block In Big Values

Light → Middle → Dark.

4. Develop the Form

Build transitions with your technique.

5. Add the Cast Shadow

Ground the object in its space.

6. Add Details Last

Texture and highlights come last.

Sketch a Day

For the next several days, complete one small observational sketch each day. These do not need to be finished artworks — they are studies. The purpose is to practice seeing and drawing.

- 1. Choose one subject.** A shoe, cup, tree, tree bark, aeaf, plants , tools, piece of fruit, chair, building, person, or household object.

3. Identify the light source. Where is the light coming from?

5. Choose one technique. Block shading, scumbling, cross-hatching, or linear shading — try a different one each day.
- 2. Spend 7–15 minutes.** Start with the basic form. Tell a story with your image and add some notes to the drawings.

4. Establish three values. Light → Middle → Dark.

6. Include a cast shadow when one is visible. Stop before it gets overly detailed.

Sketch a Day — Record

Day	Subject	Basic Form	Shading Technique	Darkest Value
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				

See the Form → Find the Light → Identify the Values → Build the Form → Add the Details

Learn to see the light and dark, and you can begin to draw the world in front of you.